

and accessibility constraints, problem solving and architectural thinking are becoming even more important. Overall, continuous hands-on learning, experimentation, and adaptation are essential to stay relevant in an AI-driven development landscape.

Q. Are there opportunities for student developers and universities?

A. It is one of the best times to be a student developer because the demand for software is increasing rapidly, which creates many real problems to solve. Students today have access to a full ecosystem of tools, from collaboration platforms like GitHub, to open source communities, to free developer resources such as the GitHub Student Developer Pack and AI tools like Copilot. These tools are not only helping students build software faster but also learn new languages, understand codebases, and explore system design in practical ways. Combined with strong community support and open access to infrastructure, students and universities now have everything needed to learn, experiment, and build real world solutions at an early stage.

Q. How are enterprises responding to AI assisted development, and what governance concerns remain?

A. Enterprises are largely focused on the productivity gains from generative AI and agentic AI, using them to accelerate product development, improve service delivery, and bring solutions to market faster. At the same time, their primary focus is on governance, guardrails, and responsible usage of AI within organisational workflows to ensure safety, compliance, and control over how AI generated code is used. Platforms like GitHub address this through tools like Copilot, which provide enterprises with built-in controls and governance mechanisms.

This balance of productivity and oversight is reflected in adoption by major organisations such as Infosys, Wipro, TVS Motors, Air India, and Paytm, along with global system integrators establishing dedicated centres of excellence to scale AI driven development effectively.

Q. Are enterprises becoming more dependent on open source ecosystems than proprietary software?

A. Yes, enterprises across startups and large organisations are increasingly recognising the value of not just adopting open source but also actively contributing back to it. Many companies now have dedicated internal teams focused on how they use open source responsibly, including contributing to projects, funding initiatives, and sponsoring ecosystem development. Programmes like the GitHub Secure Open Source Fund bring enterprises together to pool funding and improve the security and sustainability of open source projects, with participation from organisations like Zerodha. This shift reflects a broader trend where enterprises are not only consumers of open source but also active contributors, helping strengthen projects across fintech, healthcare, and software infrastructure ecosystems globally.

Q. Beyond AI platforms, what is driving this rapid growth in developers?

A. According to GitHub, a major driver is the idea that “anybody can develop,” where people no longer need formal software engineering backgrounds to build applications and solve problems. AI tools like Copilot have lowered the barrier to software creation, enabling individuals, teams, and organisations to rapidly turn ideas into working solutions. This democratisation of development, especially in a large innovation

ecosystem like India, is accelerating experimentation, hackathons, open collaboration, and real world problem solving at a much larger scale.

Q. Are Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities becoming significant contributors to GitHub's growth, and what trends are you seeing from India's developers?

A. GitHub does not track developer activity at a Tier 1, Tier 2, or Tier 3 city level, but at a country level India's developer ecosystem is showing strong and rapid growth. A key trend driving this is how AI tools like Copilot are lowering barriers for developers in smaller towns and remote regions, enabling them to build software even with limited language fluency or traditional engineering exposure. Open source collaboration is also decentralising participation, allowing developers from anywhere to contribute, fix bugs, and build projects without needing to be in major tech hubs. Together, AI and open source are making software development more accessible, inclusive, and geographically distributed, unlocking talent from across the country.

Q. Do you see India moving from a contributor economy to a product building economy in software?

A. GitHub believes India is already making that transition, with developers building globally adopted products, platforms, and open source projects rather than only contributing to existing ecosystems. Examples include HyperSwitch, Bruno, ERPNext, and the Open Healthcare Network, which has been recognised by the United Nations as a digital public good. The growing global collaboration around Indian projects, along with increasing funding, monetisation, and community support, reflects how India is emerging as a strong product and innovation driven software ecosystem. **END** 🐙